

OPERATING MANUAL · THE STEPHANE PROGRAMME V3

THE DAILY PROGRAM

Version 3.1 — Complete Edition

Two settings, one engine. A Base you adjust from for any season of life, and a Current Build tuned to right now — Irembo plus classes, through 19 July 2026.

□ **New in v3.1: Manager update slots (Tue/Fri) built into the week · TalentScreen wrap-up checklist · Recovery protocol for broken streaks · Sunday review ritual · Progress milestones so you know you're on pace · August week-by-week map**

00 · How This Works

Idea 1 · The Floor — Non-Negotiables

Three things, every single day, ~45 minutes total. They keep the streak alive on your worst days. Do only these and you’ve still won the day.

- ☐ 1 NeetCode problem — algorithms (read the pattern in the NeetCode 150 book if stuck)
- ☐ 1 Khan Academy lesson — 20 minutes minimum (math)
- ☐ 5 pages of a technical book — Physics, Maths or CS, before sleep

Missing everything is failure. Doing the floor — even on a brutal day — is not. This is the line you never cross below.

Idea 2 · Flex — Three Throttle Settings

Your energy depends on the day, so the plan bends instead of breaking. Pick a setting each morning in five seconds — no guilt.

Setting	Time	What it includes
MINIMUM	~45 min	The Non-Negotiables, nothing more. For heavy or broken days.
NORMAL	~2 hours	The floor + one curriculum project — your main engineering build.
STRONG	~3 hours +	Normal + extra: a 2nd project, a full book section, or AfriSpace / portfolio.

The 5-second morning decision

Ask one question when you wake up: “What does today already demand of me?”

- Work + class on the same day, or an event, or you slept badly → MINIMUM. Decided. No negotiation.
- Normal work day, evening free → NORMAL. This is your default.
- Free day with good energy → STRONG. Spend it on the build.

The decision takes five seconds because the options were designed in advance. You never decide what to do — only how much.

Idea 3 · Order — Think → Build → Read

Hard thinking early (NeetCode, math), build the project in the evening, read a few pages at night. Hold that order whatever your clock looks like.

One project a day, every day is the v3 dream — but it's also the fastest way to burn out and quit. This program runs the build on your good days and protects the floor on the rest. Five projects most weeks still clears all 300 in about a year. Consistency beats intensity.

Program One · The Base

Your default operating system. No Irembo, no fixed class time — just you as a student/engineer with a day that moves around. Built around parts of the day, not clock times, so it survives any schedule. Adjust everything from here.

The Daily Engine — Four Streams & Where They Live

When	Stream	What you do
MORNING (first hour)	Algorithms	1 NeetCode problem. If stuck, read its pattern in the NeetCode 150 book, then try again.
MORNING	Math	1 Khan Academy lesson, 20 min minimum. Currently climbing toward calculus.
MIDDAY (optional)	Light input	A lecture, doc, or a few pages of a language guide — only if a current project needs it.
EVENING (main block)	Build	1 project from the 300-Curriculum. Read its Companion chapter first, then build it yourself — no copying.
NIGHT (before sleep)	Read	5 pages of the Physics / Maths / CS book. Slow, with a pencil.

The Week, in the Base

- 5 build days — engine runs in full, one project each (aim Normal; spend a Strong day when you have it).
- 1 deep day (your strongest day, often a weekend) — a bigger project or catch-up, plus a full section of the Maths or Physics book, plus the CS book.
- 1 rest / life day — Non-Negotiables only. Choir, church, people, recovery. Rest is part of the program, not a failure of it.

The Reference Shelf — Pull, Don't Read Cover-to-Cover

The eight guides (Git, HTML/CSS, Python, JavaScript, SQL, C#, Docker, C++) and the SWE Master Roadmap are lookups, not daily reading. Open Git early and once, to set up your workflow. Open SQL the first time a project needs a database. Reach for HTML/CSS & JavaScript when the curriculum hits web projects; C++ & Docker in Year 2 when it reaches them.

□ **Letting these pull you off the curriculum is exactly how good intentions become thirteen half-finished plans.**

Adjusting the Base for Real Life

- Got a job / internship? The daytime is spoken for — run the engine in the evening. (That's Program Two.)
- Class moves to evenings? Swap: build in the afternoon, push reading later, or make class-evenings Minimum days.
- Exam season / heavy week? Drop to Minimum across the board, protect the streak, resume Normal after.
- Karate club or community work lands? It takes a build evening → that day becomes Minimum, and its project moves to your deep day.

Program Two · The Current Build (Now → 19 July 2026)

Irembo Mon–Fri · ALU classes online Tue & Thu (daytime, layered on Irembo). Tuesday and Thursday are your heaviest days — work and class in the same hours — so those evenings default to Minimum. Real engineering lands Mon / Wed / Fri evenings and the weekend. During work hours, Irembo gets your full focus — the program never competes with it.

The Week

Day	Daytime	Evening setting	The build
Mon	Irembo — full focus	Normal	NeetCode · Khan · 1 curriculum project · 5 pages
Tue	Irembo + class	Minimum + UPDATE	NeetCode · Khan · 5 pages · Send Tuesday evening update to Peter
Wed	Irembo — full focus	Normal	NeetCode · Khan · 1 curriculum project · 5 pages
Thu	Irembo + class	Minimum	NeetCode · Khan · 5 pages (project optional / rest)
Fri	Irembo — UPDATE first	Normal	Friday morning update to Peter BEFORE work · evening: NeetCode · Khan · 1 project · 5 pages
Sat	Free	Strong	NeetCode · Khan · 2 projects + a Maths/Physics section + CS book
Sun	Choir / church / people	Minimum + REVIEW	NeetCode · Khan · 5 pages · 15-min Sunday review · 30-min internship slot — then live your life

That's a realistic ~5 projects a week (3 weekday + 2 Saturday) without grinding yourself down — and the Non-Negotiables stay alive all 7 days. At this pace you clear the rest of Phase 1 over the summer and the full 300 in roughly a year.

Manager Updates — Now Part of the System

Peter requires updates twice a week. These are commitments, not chores — they are also how your work stays visible. They are now fixed in the weekly table above:

- Tuesday evening — short written update: what you completed, what's in progress, what's next, blockers. 10 minutes using the standard template.
- Friday morning — same format, sent BEFORE you start the work day. Set a reminder for 7:45 AM.

Light weeks get short updates. That is fine. Consistency of reporting matters more than volume of progress.

TalentScreen — The Wrap-Up Checklist

TalentScreen is deployed, but production work remains before July 19. These slot into Mon/Wed/Fri evening build blocks (they replace a curriculum project on those days) until done:

- ☐ PII anonymization — strip emails and phone numbers from resume text before sending to Groq (team security feedback — do this FIRST)
- ☐ Individual candidate profile page — full details view per candidate (manager request, priority)
- ☐ Fix Gmail OAuth code verifier error (code_challenge_method) and test scan end-to-end
- ☐ Update README with full documentation
- ☐ Google Drive upload — later, only if time remains

Order matters: security fix → profile page → Gmail → docs. If July 19 arrives with Gmail unfinished, ship without it and note it as future work. A working product with clear docs beats a feature half-done.

Where the Bigger Goals Sit Right Now

- The 300-Curriculum is the spine this summer. Keep moving through Phase 1 (you're ~#13). Most project slots go here.
- AfriSpace — light weekend touches now if you have appetite; the real push is the August sprint.
- Internship outreach is time-sensitive but small — not a daily block, just a few decisive actions. This week: email Dr. Foundjem (Polytechnique Montréal) and start the CERN application (year-round, paid, no deadline — no reason to wait). Then the 30-min Sunday slot keeps things moving. See Internship Strategy v2 for the full target list.

The Sunday Review — 15 Minutes That Run the Machine

Every Sunday, before the internship slot, answer five questions on paper or in a note. This is the feedback loop that makes the whole system self-correcting:

1. Streak check — how many of 7 days did the Non-Negotiables happen? (Target: 7. Below 5 = read the Recovery Protocol.)
2. Build count — how many curriculum projects shipped this week? (Target: ~5. Note the number, no judgment.)
3. What broke? — if a day collapsed, what actually caused it? Name it in one sentence.
4. Next week's deep day — look at the calendar. Which day is the Strong day? Protect it now.
5. One adjustment — change exactly one thing for next week. Never more than one.

Then the 30-minute internship slot:

- Check application statuses (CERN, Foundjem, CNES, Airbus, Thales, ESA)
- Send one follow-up if anything has been silent for 2+ weeks
- Advance one application by one concrete step

✓ **15 minutes of review + 30 minutes of outreach = 45 Sunday minutes that steer the entire programme. Skip everything else on Sunday if you must — not this.**

The Recovery Protocol — When the Streak Breaks

It will break. Sickness, exams, a family event, a brutal Irembo week. The difference between people who finish 300 projects and people who quit at 30 is not discipline — it is how they restart. Follow this exactly:

Missed one day

- Rule: never miss twice. The next day is automatically a Minimum day — just the floor, nothing more.
- Do NOT double up to 'catch up.' Yesterday's project is gone. Today's floor is what matters.

Missed 2–6 days

- Restart at Minimum for 2–3 days. Floor only. Rebuild the habit before rebuilding the volume.
- Then one Normal day. Then resume the week shape.
- Adjust the plan in the Sunday review: what caused the collapse? Change one thing.

Missed a week or more

- Do not re-read the whole programme. Do not redesign the system. That is procrastination wearing a productive mask.
- Tonight: 5 pages of a book. That's it. Tomorrow: full Minimum day. Day 3: Normal.
- You are back. No ceremony required.

❑ **The most dangerous thought after a broken streak is 'I'll restart properly on Monday.' You restart tonight, at whatever size tonight allows.**

Progress Milestones — How You Know You're On Pace

The daily system tells you what to do. These checkpoints tell you whether it's working. Check them at the start of each month:

Checkpoint	Target date	On-pace marker
NeetCode	End of July 2026	~50 problems done (1/day pace)
NeetCode	End of November 2026	All 150 complete — begin repeating hardest
Khan Academy	End of August 2026	Through Trigonometry
Khan Academy	End of December 2026	Differential Calculus underway
300-Curriculum	End of August 2026	~Project 45–50 (Phase 1 complete or near)
300-Curriculum	Mid-2027	All 300 complete
Books	Every month	~150 pages read (5/day) — roughly one book per term
TalentScreen	July 19, 2026	Production-complete with docs, handed over
AfriSpace	End of August 2026	Deployed with auth, posts, replies, profiles
Portfolio	End of August 2026	Exoplanet Detector + Orbit Predictor on GitHub with blog posts
Applications	End of June 2026	CERN submitted · Foundjem emailed · CNES/Airbus/Thales/ESA sent

Behind on a milestone? That's information, not failure. Find it in the Sunday review, adjust one thing, keep moving. The milestones move with reality — the floor never does.

Looking Ahead — So It Isn't a Surprise

What Changes on 19 July

Irembo ends; in August you have whole free days. This is simply the Base Program turned up to full intensity — your Year-1 Completion Sprint.

- Days open up → run two deep blocks (morning build + afternoon build). Non-Negotiables unchanged.
- Keep one true rest day a week. A sprint with no rest is how sprints die.

August — Week by Week

Week	Mission	Output
Aug 1–7	AfriSpace final push + deploy · polish both READMEs	AfriSpace live · clean GitHub
Aug 8–14	Exoplanet Detection Tool (NASA Kepler data, ML)	Deployed repo + blog post
Aug 15–21	Satellite Orbit Predictor (TLE data, physics)	Deployed repo + blog post
Aug 22–31	Consolidation · 2 NeetCode/day · curriculum sprint · application follow-ups	Enter Year 2 with full Year-1 portfolio

These two portfolio pieces are what your CERN / Polytechnique / CNES applications point to.

September — Year 2 Begins

Classes return at new times → fold them into the Base (slide build/reading blocks around class) and you're set. The engine doesn't change. Only the slots move.

Built from The Stephane Programme v3

The streak is the strategy.